Provider Enrollment Application Processing SOP

Medicare Part B individual physician enrollment through PECOS

Use this procedure to prepare, track and close an individual physician's initial Medicare Part B billing enrollment. The case owner records internal gates and external decisions separately. For group, ordering-only, Medicaid or commercial work, confirm the correct program and route before drafting. [E1–E2, E4–E5]

Ownership. The analyst owns intake, the draft and follow-up. A second reviewer clears the packet and any client hold. The eligible signer certifies the application. The Medicare Administrative Contractor (MAC) processes the filing and communicates its disposition. [E1–E2]

Intake and preparation

1. Register the request. Create one tracker case per filing. Record the individual and organization roles, payer and product, request type, practice location, related case IDs, owner and next action date. Search the queue and authorized portal for an existing filing before creating another.

2. Confirm the filing route. Use PECOS and verify the scenario and MAC for the practice location. The paper counterpart for a billing physician is CMS-855I if online filing is unavailable. CMS distinguishes this from group enrollment and ordering-only enrollment. Confirm any reassignment action separately. [E1–E2]

3. Assemble and validate the packet. Confirm an active individual NPI and reconcile the legal name, professional license, practice location and other required fields. Use the current PECOS prompts for attachments, disclosures and any applicable electronic funds transfer or fee. Obtain sensitive inputs through approved secure channels. In the tracker, reference the evidence without recording SSNs, bank details or login credentials. [E2]

4. Clear the submission gate. Reconcile the draft to source evidence and resolve material discrepancies. The reviewer checks application type, correct location and linkage, attachments, signing authority, open holds and duplicates. Record the review date and evidence. Move to Ready to submit after clearance. Authorized support users may help prepare the application. Route certification to the eligible signer. [E2]

Portfolio example. For fictional ENR-001, the team received the request November 5, 2026. It is still on Hold as of November 10, with follow-up November 12 for a CME certificate (VER-003). The CME hold comes from the sample client policy. The exercise shows a pre-submission case with no external deadline or effective date.

Submission tracking and closure

5. File and log the receipt. Obtain the applicable signature and certification, submit the cleared version and store the receipt, tracking ID, submission date, MAC and submitted version reference. Set Submitted only after obtaining evidence of transmission. Check PECOS or contact the MAC before retrying an unconfirmed submission. [E1–E2]

6. Handle requests for information. Track status using PECOS or the MAC. For a Development request, capture the notice, receipt date, exact requested items, external deadline, owner and earlier internal target where feasible. Escalate an at-risk or missed deadline immediately. Record response date, submitted evidence and receipt. [E1–E2]

7. Close and hand off. Record the written decision, relevant provider and location scope, notice date and confirmed effective date. Use Approval received while scope or dates remain unresolved. A reviewer reconciles the decision before marking Closed approved and handing the verified terms to the client or billing team. For adverse outcomes, preserve the exact payer disposition, notify the lead and follow the notice's review or resubmission instructions. [E2–E3]

Operational stage	Evidence or condition	Owner action
Intake or Hold	New request or documented block.	Assign an owner, next action and follow-up date.
Ready to submit	Approved packet and eligible signer.	Submit the cleared version and keep the receipt.
Submitted	Portal or MAC confirmation.	Track payer response and check before resubmitting.
Development request	MAC request and deadline.	Meet the dated notice or escalate the risk. Log the response receipt.
Approval received	Approval notice with closure checks pending.	Confirm scope and effective date before handoff.
Closed approved, Closed denied or Withdrawn	Reconciled decision or documented withdrawal and handoff.	Preserve the exact disposition. Record the agreed next action.

Date controls

Keep intake, submission, response due, internal follow-up, decision and effective dates in separate fields. For physicians under 42 CFR 424.520(d), the effective date is the later of the filing date of the application the MAC ultimately approves and the first service date at the new location. Record the date the MAC confirms and escalate any conflict. [E3]

Program routing and source register

Confirm the payer, product, provider type, location and requested action before reusing any checklist. Apply the payer's current directions to documents, signatures, status, deadlines and release.

Scope	Routing reference	Limit
Original Medicare Part B	PECOS and the assigned MAC. [E1–E2]	The detailed procedure covers initial individual physician billing enrollment.
California Medi-Cal physician	California DHCS directs MD applications to PAVE. [E4]	Use the provider-specific instructions. Managed care contracting is a separate scope.
UnitedHealthcare medical network	Check Onboard Pro and the applicable market or product. [E5]	Credentialing and contracting each have their own status and evidence.

Official sources

All sources accessed November 10, 2026.

[E1] CMS | Become a Medicare Provider or Supplier

Outlines NPI, PECOS, conditional fee and MAC steps. Confirm the correct pathway for the applicant.

www.cms.gov/medicare/enrollment-renewal/providers-suppliers

[E2] CMS | Medicare Provider Enrollment MLN9658742

Explains forms, application workflow, access roles and status. Use current PECOS prompts and the MAC's case-specific notice.

www.cms.gov/Outreach-and-Education/Medicare-Learning-Network-MLN/MLNProducts/EnrollmentResources/provider-resources/provider-enrolment/Med-Prov-Enroll-MLN9658742.html

[E3] Electronic Code of Federal Regulations | 42 CFR 424.520

Paragraph (d) describes effective dates for physicians and other listed types. This section alone does not resolve retrospective billing.

www.ecfr.gov/current/title-42/chapter-IV/subchapter-B/part-424/subpart-P/section-424.520

[E4] California DHCS | Doctor of Medicine Application Information

Provides PAVE routing and required-document guidance for the covered Medi-Cal physician applications.

www.dhcs.ca.gov/providers-partners/doctor-of-medicine-application-information/

[E5] UnitedHealthcare | Join Our Network Medical Providers

Describes Onboard Pro and distinct credentialing and contracting steps for the covered medical network.

www.uhcprovider.com/en/resource-library/Join-Our-Network/Medical-Provider.html